■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, September 04, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Illinois chiropractor pleads guilty to secret recording of undressing patients*

The Angle: *Illinois chiropractor pleads guilty to secret recording of undressing patients*

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMitwFBVV95cUxOQ2lzZEtLZnVDLWdHU2Z0MG00OHZyMGFVRW5FVzh6MEZBUG5oVUJ2Sm83T1hta0VEcFprZFNFSXNHMnI1SXlaU1prNDBiakxkYzF2dzd1LTd2MmYwRS1HNUdmaWlmUVBZSDVxR1VTZTdqT2tENlY1Q0duSThUdXlWSXdoQlpnenVwQ3NYY09fdDFZQkRudUZoclhIZjVjMnBHcFV5ZXBkeWZpYWdOWVNQVHR4cGF4eWc?oc=5

■ *Microsoft Announces Big Changes to Xbox Cloud Gaming, Switches to Monthly Hour Limits*

The Angle: *Microsoft Announces Big Changes to Xbox Cloud Gaming, Switches to Monthly Hour Limits*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ign.com/articles/microsoft-announces-big-changes-to-xbox-cloud-gaming-switches-to-monthly-hour-limits

■ *White House launches arcade site featuring border wall 'horde' game*

The Angle: *White House launches arcade site featuring border wall 'horde' game*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.washingtonexaminer.com/news/white-house/4712984/white-house-arcade-site-border-horde-game-detaining-immigrant-themes/

■ *Genetically modified pig kidney keeps man alive for record nine months. Organ kept Tim Andrews off dialysis and acted as a 'bridge' while he waited for a human transplant in the US.*

The Angle: *Genetically modified pig kidney keeps man alive for record nine months. Organ kept Tim Andrews off dialysis and acted as a 'bridge' while he waited for a human transplant in the US.*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://theguardian.com/science/2026/sep/03/genetically-modified-pig-kidney-keeps-man-alive-record-nine-months

■ *Experimental One-Dose Treatment Cuts 'Bad' Cholesterol by 52% in First Human Trial: a precise DNA-editing approach, using CRISPR technology to make a permanent genetic change that could durably reduce LDL cholesterol after a single treatment.*

The Angle: *Scientists just used CRISPR gene-editing to permanently slash 'bad' cholesterol with a single treatment - no more daily statins, no more pill bottles. It's the kind of medical leap that sounds like sci-fi but could change how we treat heart disease, the #1 killer in North America.*

- A **single dose** cut **LDL ('bad') cholesterol by 52%** in the first human trial participants.
- The treatment uses **CRISPR DNA-editing technology** to make a **permanent genetic change**.
- Unlike statins you take daily for life, this is designed as a **one-and-done** fix.

The Debate Starter

- Would you let scientists permanently edit your genes to never worry about cholesterol again?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/experimental-one-dose-treatment-cuts-bad-cholesterol-by-52-in-first-human-trial

Backup options:

■■ *MapQuest tops Apple, Google Maps in downloads after refusing Trump's 'Lake America' change*

The Angle: *A 2000s throwback app suddenly topping the App Store because it refused a Trump-driven rename is exactly the kind of underdog-vs-politics story that gets people picking sides for reasons that have nothing to do with directions.*

- **MapQuest** reportedly jumped ahead of **Apple Maps** and **Google Maps** in downloads
- The spike is tied to MapQuest refusing to go along with a push from **Trump** to rename it 'Lake America'
- The story is circulating heavily out of **r/canada**, framing it as a small company standing its ground

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually switch map apps just to make a political point?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thehill.com/homenews/administration/6063924-mapquest-tops-apple-google-maps-in-downloads-after-refusing-trumps-lake-america-change/?r

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■ *‘Ellison Is Trump’s B!tch!’ Banner Flies Over Paramount Lot in Protest of Warner Bros. Merger*

The Angle: *Someone paid for a plane to drag a profanity-laced banner over the Paramount lot taking a shot at the studio's ownership and the Warner Bros. merger — guerrilla Hollywood protest theater doesn't get much louder than literal skywriting.*

- A banner reading **'Ellison Is Trump's B*tch!'** flew over the **Paramount** studio lot.
- The stunt appears to be a protest tied to the **Warner Bros.** merger deal.
- Photos of the banner started circulating out of **Reddit's r/entertainment**.

The Debate Starter

- Skywriting protests used to be a wedding-proposal gimmick — now they're aimed at billion-dollar studio mergers, so what does that tell you about how mad people actually are at Hollywood right now?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/plan-banner-ellison-is-trumps-bitch-1236850859/

■■ *An “Ellison is Trump’s Bitch” banner is circling Paramount's lot in L.A. David Ellison is the CEO of Paramount Skydance.*

The Angle: *A banner plane calling out Paramount Skydance CEO David Ellison by name was spotted circling the studio's L.A. lot - a very public, very petty jab at Hollywood's newest power player that's tailor-made for a 'who did this and why' debate.*

- A banner reading **"Ellison is Trump's Bitch"** was spotted flying over **Paramount's studio lot** in L.A.
- **David Ellison** is the CEO of **Paramount Skydance**.
- The story is circulating out of Hollywood-gossip circles on Reddit, with no official comment from the studio yet.

The Debate Starter

- Who's behind the banner - a rival, a disgruntled staffer, or just a troll with a plane and a grudge?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/s0p3m3f31dnh1.jpeg

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Carney says Trump officials shouldn't comment on Canadian politics*

The Angle: *Canada's PM is publicly telling the Trump administration to butt out of Canadian political affairs — a direct jab that plays into the ongoing tension between Ottawa and Washington.*

- **PM Mark Carney** says **Trump administration officials** should not be weighing in on **Canadian politics**.
- Comes amid ongoing friction between **Ottawa** and **Washington** over cross-border political commentary.

The Debate Starter

- Should foreign officials ever get a pass to comment on another country's politics — or is Carney right to draw the line?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/politics/article/carney-says-trump-officials-shouldnt-comment-on-canadian-politics/

■ *Canada's new vertical $20 bank note*

The Angle: *The Bank of Canada is rolling out a new $20 bill in a vertical layout, a first for our currency — it's the kind of everyday change that gets people talking the second it hits their wallet.*

- The **Bank of Canada** is introducing a redesigned **$20 note** in a **vertical orientation**
- It marks a departure from the traditional horizontal layout Canadians have used their whole lives

The Wallet Chat

- Vertical bills — smart modern upgrade, or just going to mess up every wallet and cash register in the country?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bankofcanada.ca/banknotes/vertical-20-note-security-features/vertical-20-note-design-elements/?page_moved=1

🛩■ *Saab intensifies pitch to sell Gripen jets to Canada, promising assortment of benefits*

The Angle: *Saab is stepping up its sales pitch to Canada for its Gripen fighter jet, dangling extra perks to sweeten the deal - a story that plays into the bigger, ongoing debate about whether Canada sticks with American-made jets or looks elsewhere for its next fighter fleet.*

- **Saab**, the Swedish defense manufacturer, is ramping up its pitch to sell Canada the **Gripen** fighter jet
- The company is promising an **"assortment of benefits"** as part of the offer
- Comes as Canada continues weighing its options for its fighter jet program

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada snub American jets and buy Swedish instead - does that even matter to you?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/canada/article-saab-gripen-fighter-jet-production/

Backup options:

■ *Ottawa spending $4.7B on new made-in-Canada Via Rail passenger cars*

The Angle: *Multi-billion dollar taxpayer spend on new made-in-Canada passenger cars is the kind of number that gets people talking about priorities, especially if their local Via route still feels stuck in the '90s.*

- The federal government is committing **$4.7 billion** to new **Via Rail** passenger cars.
- The cars are being built **in Canada**, tying the project to domestic manufacturing jobs.

The Debate Starter

- Is $4.7 billion on new train cars smart infrastructure investment or another government project that runs over budget?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/northern-ontario/article/ottawa-spending-47b-on-new-made-in-canada-via-rail-passenger-cars/

■■ *Canadians are being warned to prepare for a 5 C hotter future*

The Angle: *This isn't a far-off doomsday number - it's a planning warning, and it hits home because it touches everything from how we build houses to how we dress for winter (or don't, anymore).*

- The warning centers on Canada facing a **5°C** rise in future temperatures
- Framed as a call to **prepare now**, not just a distant forecast

The Debate Starter

- Phones open: what's the one thing about your day-to-day life you think changes first in a 5-degrees-hotter Canada?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/climate-change-impact-canada-report-9.7331893?cmp=rss

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■ *Health-care hiring has propped up Canada's job market. Will patients see a difference?*

The Angle: *Canada's job numbers look decent on paper, but strip out health-care hiring and the rest of the economy is basically flat — which raises the real question of whether patients are actually getting better care or just paying for more admin.*

- Health-care hiring in **Alberta** and **Ontario** is being credited as the main engine keeping **Canada's national job market** afloat.
- The growth is being read as a red flag for the broader economy, not a win — it suggests **most other sectors** aren't hiring.
- The open question: does more health-care staffing on paper actually mean **shorter wait times or better patient outcomes**?

The Debate Starter

- If your province's 'booming job market' is really just hospitals hiring, does that make you feel better or worse about the economy?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/health/health-jobs-growth-alberta-ontario-9.7329685?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Nicole Kidman Wanted To Star In A 'Dune' Film But Denis Villeneuve "Never Asks" Her To Star In His Films: "I'm Obsessed"*

The Angle: *One of Hollywood's biggest names is publicly campaigning to work with a director who keeps snubbing her — that's the kind of star-crush-gone-unrequited story that's just fun to dig into.*

- **Nicole Kidman** says she wants to star in a **Dune** film.
- She says director **Denis Villeneuve** "never asks" her to be in his movies.
- Kidman's own words: **"I'm obsessed"** with his films.

The Dream Casting

- Which director do you wish would finally just call you already?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://deadline.com/2026/09/nicole-kidman-wanted-star-dune-film-1237067699/

■■ *Abdul El-Sayed: "There are 3M people who listen to Hasan. I want to offer them a pathway into an electoral movement where rather than sit outside the electoral system... I'm glad to be on your show, but I'm not here to talk to you. I'm here to talk to the people you're talking to"*

The Angle: *A Michigan candidate used airtime on streamer Hasan Piker's massive show to basically say the quiet part out loud — he's not there for Hasan, he's there to recruit Hasan's 3 million viewers into voting. It's a blunt look at how politicians are courting influencer audiences directly now.*

- **Abdul El-Sayed** name-checked **Hasan Piker's** reach directly: **"There are 3M people who listen to Hasan"**
- He said the goal is offering those viewers **"a pathway into an electoral movement"** instead of staying outside the system
- The kicker line to his own host: **"I'm glad to be on your show, but I'm not here to talk to you. I'm here to talk to the people you're talking to"**

The Debate Starter

- Savvy political strategy or kind of a cold thing to say to the guy who invited you on?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/4t4c8exbvcnh1

■■ *Ulta Beauty is one of Flock's biggest commercial customers*

The Angle: *A viral Reddit thread claims Ulta Beauty is one of the biggest retail clients of Flock Safety, the AI license-plate-reader company under fire for its ties to police and immigration surveillance - and now shoppers are asking if their favorite beauty store is watching them.*

- **Flock Safety** makes AI-powered license plate readers now used by thousands of police departments and private companies across the US
- **Ulta Beauty** is being called out as one of **Flock's** biggest commercial customers, according to a thread blowing up on **r/fauxmoi**
- The claim is landing amid a broader wave of backlash over **Flock's** data-sharing with law enforcement and immigration authorities

The Boycott Debate

- Would a surveillance-tech tie make you rethink shopping at Ulta?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/q6yscy9judnh1

■ *'Wheel of Fortune' Announcer Jim Thornton Suspended After Allegedly Accessing Disturbing Website while on Flight*

The Angle: *A recognizable voice from a beloved game show getting suspended over something "disturbing" on a plane is exactly the kind of only-in-2026 celebrity scandal that gets phones ringing.*

- **Jim Thornton**, the longtime announcer on **Wheel of Fortune**, has reportedly been suspended.
- The suspension allegedly stems from him accessing a **"disturbing" website** while on a flight.
- Details are still thin — the story is circulating via **r/fauxmoi**, with no official statement yet.

The Speculation Starter

- What's more shocking to you: the show it happened on, or that we still don't know what he was actually looking at?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tvinsider.com/1285518/wheel-of-fortunes-jim-thornton-suspended-disturbing-website/

Backup options:

■ *Cole Sprouse says he no longer speaks to his mother but still honors the vision she once had for him and Dylan: "There was once a woman who was very clear-headed and who had a beautiful vision of the kind of people my brother and I could be, and in very many ways I honor the dream she once had."*

The Angle: *A former child star getting candid about estrangement from a parent is always a watercooler moment, especially wrapped in the bittersweet twist that he still honors the dream she had for him and twin*

brother Dylan.

- **Cole Sprouse** revealed he **no longer speaks to his mother**.
- He says she was once "**very clear-headed**" with a "**beautiful vision**" of who he and **Dylan** could become.
- Despite the estrangement, Cole says he still tries to "**honor the dream she once had**" for them.
- The comments are circulating via **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**.

The Debate Starter

- Can you still honor a parent's vision for you after you've cut them out of your life?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/qk8s5mwdrenh1

■ *Ryan Reynolds, Kenneth Branagh-starring Mayday takes on Russia. And America*

The Angle: *A critic basically admits they didn't want to like this one - calling it propaganda - and then says it works anyway. That's a great setup for a movie debate segment.*

- New film **Mayday** stars **Kenneth Branagh** and **Ryan Reynolds**
- The story reportedly squares off against **Russia... and America**
- **CBC's** review calls it "a form of propaganda" that "actually does completely work"
- Reviewer admits it'd be "depressing" if a movie like this succeeded - and says it did anyway

The Debate Starter

- Can a movie be propaganda AND still be great - where's the line for you?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/mayday-review-9.7331843?cmp=rss

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■ *Hollywood power couple awkwardly promoting their next film project after bitter split — 'They despise each other!'*

The Angle: *A once-beloved Hollywood couple has to sit side by side and sell a movie together after a messy breakup, and the tension is reportedly leaking through every interview — that's must-watch car-crash energy for anyone who loves celebrity drama.*

- A former **Hollywood power couple** is currently doing press together for their **latest film project**, despite having split.
- An insider claims **"They despise each other!"** behind the scenes of the promo tour.
- The pair are reportedly forcing smiles for cameras while the real story plays out off-camera.

The Debate Starter

- Could you sit through a press tour smiling next to your ex, or would you have bailed on the movie entirely?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/04/hollywood/hollywood-power-couple-awkwardly-promoting-their-next-film-project-after-bitter-split-they-despise-each-other/

■ *Inside George and Amal Clooney's night out at Venice power dinner — as couple returns to fave restaurant where star had bachelor party*

The Angle: *George and Amal Clooney hit up Venice's power-dinner scene during the Film Festival, and it's the restaurant angle that makes it juicy — this is the same spot where Clooney threw his own bachelor party.*

- Spotted at **Da Ivo**, described as Clooney's favorite restaurant in **Venice**
- Outing happened during the **Venice Film Festival**
- George was seen taking photos with the **kitchen staff**
- Da Ivo is reportedly the site of Clooney's own **bachelor party**

The Debate Starter

- Would you ever go back to your bachelor/bachelorette party spot for a date night with your spouse?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/04/hollywood/inside-george-and-amal-clooneys-night-out-at-venice-power-dinner/

TRENDING TODAY

■■■■ *The viral Conair mini heated brush came with me on date night — and my hair never looked better*

The Angle: *A viral mini heated brush is blowing up online for delivering salon-smooth hair in minutes flat - the kind of quick-fix beauty gadget that always sparks a 'does it actually work?' debate.*

- The **Conair mini heated brush** is going viral as a portable styling fix
- One writer says it only took **two minutes** to heat up before a date night
- Marketed as a grab-and-go tool for last-minute hair emergencies

The Try-It Challenge

- Anyone actually tested the viral heated brush trend, or is it all hype?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/04/shopping/conair-5-minute-fix-brush-review-my-date-night-test/

Backup options:

■ *Romanian prosecutors indict influencer Andrew Tate for trafficking minors, money laundering*

The Angle: *The influencer who built an empire on controversy is now facing formal charges in Romania, not just allegations — this has been simmering for years and now it's real, with his brother Tristan charged too.*

- **Romanian prosecutors** officially indicted **Andrew Tate** on Friday
- Charges include **trafficking minors**, **money laundering**, **sex with a minor**, and **witness tampering**
- Brother **Tristan Tate** indicted for **complicity**
- Investigation into the pair has been ongoing for **years**

The Debate Starter

- Does this finally end Tate's influence, or does his fanbase spin an indictment into another 'they're out to get me' narrative?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/andrew-tate-indicted-trafficking-minors-romanian-prosecutors-9.7332173?cmp=rss

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■ *Nvidia to buy open-source AI platform Hugging Face for $13bn - Financial Times*

The Angle: *Nvidia's chips already power basically every AI boom out there, and now they're buying Hugging Face, the go-to hub where developers share and download AI models for free - a company that literally turned Nvidia down before to stay independent.*

- **Nvidia** is acquiring **Hugging Face** for **$13 billion**
- **Hugging Face** is the open-source hub developers use to share and download AI models
- The company reportedly **turned down a big investment** from **Jensen Huang's** chip empire last year to protect its independence
- Now that independence is gone - Nvidia's writing the check this time

The Debate Starter

- Does Big Tech buying up the 'open' and 'independent' corners of AI worry you, or is this just how every good tech story ends?

Financial Times (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ft.com/content/776dcb01-75cd-44df-bc52-63ca76d5718d?syn-25a6b1a6\\u003d1

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Offshore wind farms are becoming unexpected havens for marine life. Researchers found 97 fish species and more than 11,500 fish around turbines in Taiwan, while New York's Empire Wind is now creating similar new habitat across its 54 offshore foundations.*

The Angle: *Offshore wind gets slammed as an eyesore, but it turns out the turbines are basically artificial reefs — a fun, counterintuitive twist that flips the usual energy-vs-nature debate on its head.*

- Researchers counted **97 different fish species** living around turbines off the coast of **Taiwan**
- More than **11,500 fish** were found clustered around those same turbine foundations
- New York's **Empire Wind** project is seeing the same effect, building new habitat across **54 offshore foundations**

The Watercooler Take

- Would it change how you feel about wind farms if you knew they were basically building coral reefs for fish?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/engineers-drove-enormous-steel-foundations-directly-into-bare-atlantic-sand-to-hold-offshore-wind-turbines-upright-and-what-happens-around-those-artificial-structures-afterward-is-changing-the-seabed/36110/

Backup options:

■ *A Ugandan woman who grew up in an orphanage and battled malaria as a child founded a prevention company with $30 for field research. Uganics now serves 4.5 million people across 8 countries, with participating households reporting malaria reductions of nearly 90%.*

The Angle: *This is the ultimate underdog story: an orphan who survived malaria herself turned $30 into a company protecting millions — the kind of feel-good, against-all-odds story that makes for great water-cooler talk.*

- **Joan Rukundo Nalubega** grew up in an orphanage in **Uganda** and battled **malaria** herself as a kid
- She launched her company, **Uganics**, starting with just **$30** for field research
- Uganics now reaches **4.5 million people** across **8 countries**
- Participating households report malaria cases dropping by nearly **90%** — and she just landed on **Forbes Africa's 30 Under 30**

The Inspiration Angle

- What's the smallest amount of money you'd need to start something that could actually change the world?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.alueducation.com/from-personal-loss-to-public-health-innovation-reimagining-malaria-prevention-through-uganics/

■ *Texas just brought only the third next generation geothermal power plant in US history onto the grid. The 3 MW pilot has produced electricity reliably for more than 120 days, proving geothermal can deliver clean power around the clock regardless of weather or time of day.*

The Angle: *This is only the third next-gen geothermal plant ever to go live in the US, and it's proof clean energy doesn't have to depend on sunny skies or windy days - it just ran nonstop for four months straight.*

- The pilot plant is in **Texas** and just came online
- It's only the **third** next-generation geothermal power plant in **US history**
- It's a **3 MW** pilot project
- It's delivered **reliable electricity for 120+ days**, day or night, regardless of weather

The Watercooler Angle

- Texas - oil and gas country - just became a clean energy pioneer. Did not see that plot twist coming.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.canarymedia.com/articles/geothermal/sage-geosystems-next-gen-geothermal-online

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■ *After 9 days, voices heard from the hydro tunnel buried in Nepal flood, rescue team say*

The Angle: *Nine days after a hydro tunnel collapsed in a Nepal flood, rescue crews say they've heard voices coming from inside — turning what looked like a lost cause into a real-time survival story people can't stop watching.*

- Workers have been trapped inside a **hydro tunnel** in **Nepal** for **9 days** after it was buried in flooding.
- **Rescue teams** now say they've heard **voices** from within the tunnel, raising hope survivors are still alive.

The Hope Check

- Nine days buried and rescuers just heard someone knocking back — that's the kind of update that gives you chills.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://kathmandupost.com/national/2026/09/04/voices-heard-from-inside-trishuli-3a-hydropower-tunnel-says-lawmaker

Backup options:

■ *Horoscope for Thursday, September 03, 2026 - Chicago Sun-Times*

The Angle: *Classic light close-out segment - everyone secretly checks their horoscope, and it's an easy way to get both hosts talking about their signs before you send it home.*

- **Moon Alert**: no restrictions on shopping or big decisions after **7 a.m.** today
- The moon is parked in **Gemini**
- **Aries** (March 21-April 19): impulsive, but also **highly creative** today

The Sign Check

- Trade zodiac signs on air and read each other's forecast - see if it actually lands.

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Sign Swap** - 15 seconds -> Each host says their zodiac sign out loud before hearing the forecast.
- **Step 2: Read the Forecast** - 20-30 seconds -> Read each other's horoscope snippet live off the page.
- **Step 3: Verdict** - 10 seconds -> Hosts rate how accurate it feels - thumbs up or total miss - before tossing to goodbyes.

Suntimes.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://chicago.suntimes.com/horoscopes/2026/09/03/horoscopes-today-thursday-september-03-2026

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/4 this month; TECH TALK 1/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Hayden Panettiere was haunted by crippling back pain from bizarre on-set zebra accident" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-19)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 10 banked (+15 each when found)

- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she’s sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)
- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to "The Fast and the Furious" 25th Anniversary Screening in LA https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)
- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt ‘Disappointed’ by BLACKPINK’s 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)
- "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite’s ‘Override’ Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary ‘B’Day’ Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "‘A modern Dickie Dee bike’: Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- www.huffpost.com (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 4 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-04 01:17 PM